



Plants for walls, fences, and vertical surfaces

Plants that scramble up vertical surfaces are chiefly useful in small gardens where they bolster color and interest while taking up little ground space.

Many climbers and shrubs prefer their roots shaded, while their stems clamber or are trained toward the sun. Clematis are a perfect example, and most are happy if their top growth can bathe in sunlight for a few hours each day in summer. Some clematis, including 'Niobe', bloom on north-facing walls, while others like 'Nelly Moser' prefer shade as the sun can bleach out their subtle flower colors. Deep shade is not a problem for natural forest dwellers, such as Virginia creeper and Boston ivy, while those used to life on the edge of a woodland, like hydrangea and honeysuckle need sunshine for part of the day.



CLIMBER MEDIUM

Clematis alpina

ALPINE CLEMATIS A deciduous climber with divided midgreen leaves. From early- to late spring, it bears lantern-shaped blue, pink, or white flowers, depending on the variety, followed by fluffy silvery seedheads. Keep the roots shaded.

†10ft (3m)

☀ Z4–9



CLIMBER LARGE

Clematis 'Bill MacKenzie'

CLEMATIS A deciduous climber with dark green leaves and bell-shaped, waxy yellow flowers that appear from midsummer to late fall. The blooms are followed by fluffy seedheads. Requires a large support. Cut back in late winter or early spring.

†22ft (7m)

☀ Z5–9



CLIMBER MEDIUM

Clematis cirrhosa

EARLY VIRGIN'S-BOWER This evergreen climber has jagged-edged green leaves. From late winter to early spring, it produces small, bell-shaped cream flowers that are spotted red inside. Provide a sturdy support and a sheltered site; shade the roots.

†10ft (3m)

☀ Z7–11



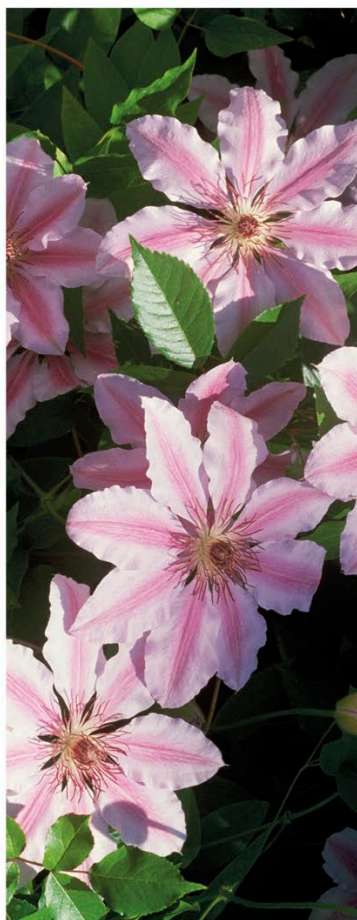
CLIMBER LARGE

Clematis montana

HIMALAYAN CLEMATIS A deciduous climber with divided midgreen foliage. From late spring to early summer, it bears numerous scented white blooms with yellow centers. Provide a large support, such as a tree, large wall, or pergola.

†40ft (12m)

☀ Z6–9



CLIMBER MEDIUM

Clematis 'Nelly Moser'

CLEMATIS This medium-sized deciduous climber has dark green leaves. In early summer, it produces large rose-mauve blooms, with a carmine stripe on each petal, followed by globular seedheads. Trim lightly after flowering if needed.

†10ft (3m)

☀ Z4–9



CLIMBER MEDIUM

Clematis 'Niobe'

CLEMATIS This is a deciduous climber with dark green leaves. Throughout summer, it produces masses of velvety, deep red single flowers that have contrasting yellow anthers. Trim lightly after flowering if needed.

†10ft (3m)

☀ Z4–9